

1. Allocation Package Narrative

As stated in the guidelines, a declaration that SB125 funding will not be used for operating may take the place of the narrative explanation, if applicable.

- i. An explanation of what funding and service actions are being taken within the region that utilize resources other than SB 125 funding.*

Not applicable. See declaration in Appendix A.

- ii. A description and justification of the RTPA strategy to use SB 125 funding to construct capital projects and fund operating expenses that lead to improved outcomes in its jurisdictions.*

Not applicable. See declaration in Appendix A.

- iii. A detailed breakdown and justification for how the funding is proposed to be distributed between transit operators and among projects, consistent with the legislative intent described in SB 125.*

RCTC staff reviewed Commission-approved plans and priorities that are in line with the SB125 guidelines, including the Traffic Relief Plan, Short Range Transit Plans, and Grade Separation Prioritization Study to identify projects within the county to be funded, and identified two project categories:

1. Zero Emission and Transit Capital - RCTC consulted with each of the seven (7) transit bus operators and the regional rail provider, Metrolink, on their major capital needs. RCTC requested a list of projects from each of the operators to prioritize zero emission projects and related facility upgrades. The total requested funds exceeded the funding available, therefore, the minimum required baseline zero emission infrastructure such as electric chargers, hydrogen fueling stations, first batch of buses, and maintenance facility upgrades were prioritized.
2. Passenger Rail Project Development – This will support the project development of the Coachella Valley Rail (CV Rail) Project, one of the Commission’s top priority projects. This project will include the commencement of the Tier 2 environmental document for CV Rail and the preliminary engineering of three (3) grade separations along the corridor identified in RCTC’s Grade Separation Prioritization Study – Pennsylvania Ave in the City of Beaumont, Hargrave Ave in the City of Banning, and Broadway in unincorporated Cabazon.

For more information, please see a copy of the staff report approved on December 12, 2023, in Appendix B.

2. Detailed Project Description

The following pages include the requested project details for the two projects included in this submittal.

1. Zero Emission and Transit Capital Program (TIRCP & ZETCP Capital)

- a. Project Details Summary with explanation of GHG, ridership benefits, disadvantaged communities impact
- b. Maps for each of the following:
 - a. Project location
 - b. Transit routes and disadvantaged communities
 - c. Housing density
 - d. Employment centers

Note: KMZ file provided in transmittal.

- c. CARB Quantification Methodologies and calculator tools – see Appendix C and Excel file provided in transmittal
- d. CARB Job co-benefit modeling tool (ZETCP projects) – see Appendix D and Excel file provided in transmittal
- e. CARB Benefit criteria table (ZETCP projects) – see Appendix E and Excel file provided in transmittal

2. Passenger Rail Project Development (TIRCP Capital)

- a. Project Details Summary with explanation of GHG, ridership benefits, disadvantaged communities impact
- b. Description and map designating project location. Note: KMZ file provided in transmittal.
- c. Maps for each of the following:
 - i. Project location
 - ii. Transit routes and disadvantaged communities
 - iii. Housing density
 - iv. Employment centers

SB125 Allocation Package – Project Details

Project Type:	New TIRCP & ZETCP Capital Program	Date:	12/22/2023
Implementing Agencies:	Riverside Transit Agency (RTA); SunLine Transit Agency; Palo Verde Valley Transit Agency (PVVTA); cities of Banning, Beaumont, Corona, and Riverside		
Project Title:	Zero Emission and Transit Capital Projects		
Project Manager/Contact	Phone	E-mail Address	
Lorelle Moe-Luna, Multimodal Services Director	Mobile: (951) 529 – 5815	lmoe-luna@rctc.org	

Summary of Project Scope

The program will include the construction and implementation of four main project components:

- 1) Maintenance facility upgrades – Includes new maintenance facilities for PVVTA and City of Beaumont as their current maintenance yards are outdoor and/or insufficient for zero emission technology and future growth, and other facility upgrades such as SunLine’s microgrid project that will support renewable energy.
- 2) Zero-emission infrastructure – Includes upgrading power supplies, electric charging stations and dispensers at transit facilities in the cities of Banning, Beaumont, Corona, and Riverside; and hydrogen fueling stations at transit facilities in Riverside and Hemet for RTA, in Blythe for PVVTA, and cities of Beaumont and Corona.
- 3) Zero-emission buses – Includes a total of 28 electric buses and 39 hydrogen buses that will operate throughout Riverside County.
- 4) Integrated ticketing systems – Includes the installation of open loop fare payment technology for new vehicles.

Current Status

Infrastructure projects will begin the planning and preliminary engineering phases of the project in FY 24/25 for completion by the end of 2026. Construction is estimated to begin in 2027.

Buses and integrated ticketing systems will be ordered as early as 2026 for delivery and implementation by 2030 or sooner. Each bus procurement is about an 18-month period.

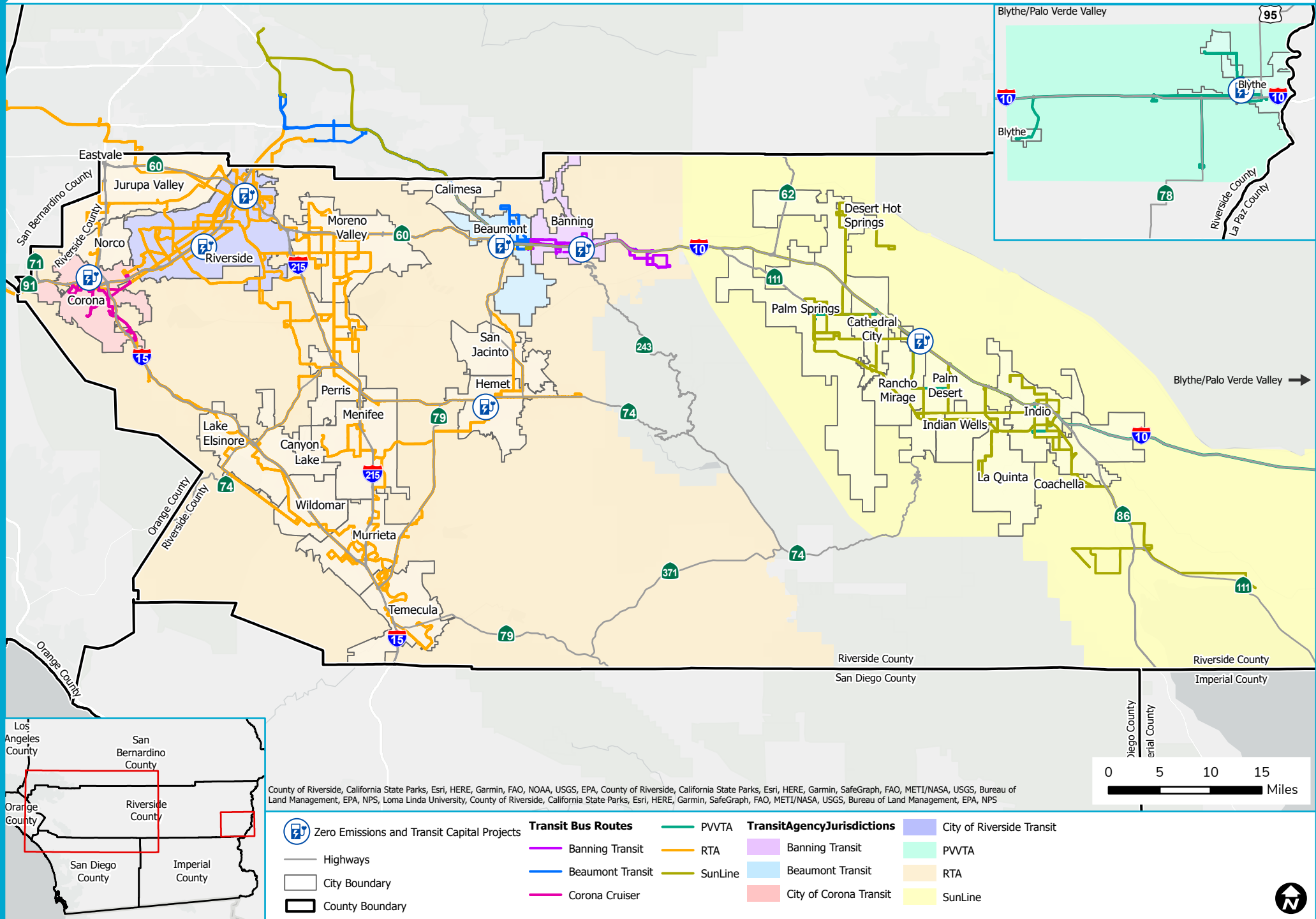
Project Schedule and Milestones			Proposed Completion Date
Begin Environmental Phase	Document Type	CE	9/1/2024
End Environmental Phase			9/30/2025
Begin Design Phase			1/2/2026
End Design Phase			12/30/2026
Begin Right of Way Phase			n/a
End Right of Way Phase			n/a
Begin Construction Phase/ Bus Purchase			7/1/2027
End Construction Phase/ Bus Purchase			12/30/20

Total Project Costs (\$1,000s)				
	TIRCP Formula	ZETCP	Other *	Total
PAED			\$ 7,000,000	\$ 7,000,000
ROW				\$ -
CON	\$ 62,591,486	\$ 14,828,290	\$ 15,190,000	\$ 92,609,776
TOTAL	\$ 62,591,486	\$ 14,828,290	\$ 22,190,000	\$ 99,609,776

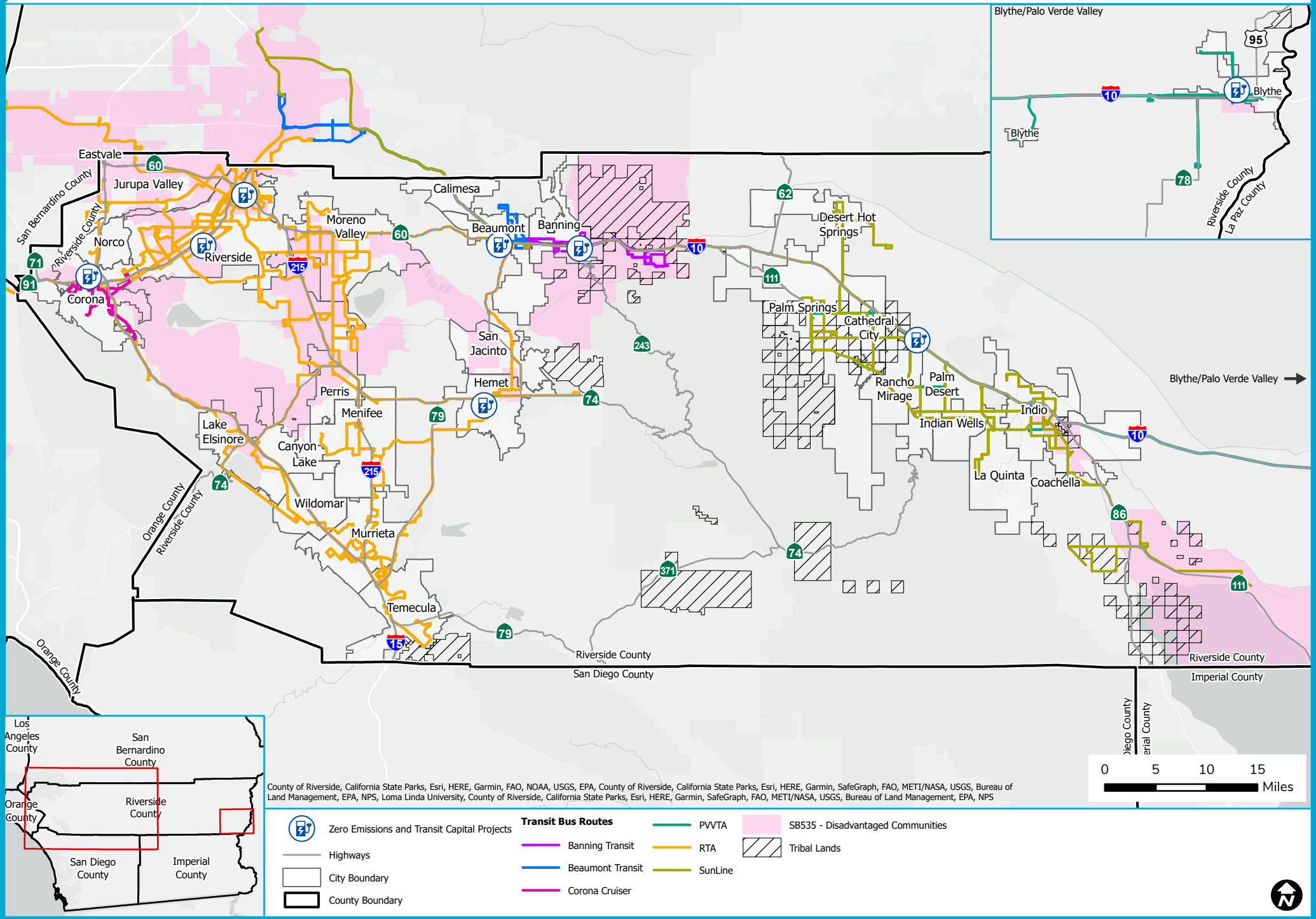
*Other funds include STA, LCTOP, SB1 SGR, FTA formula, and competitive state and federal funds.

1. Is this for an existing TIRCP project? If yes, please explain the reason for additional funds being needed and skip #2, 3, and 4.	☐ Yes ☒ No
2. Greenhouse Gas Reductions Benefits	
Riverside County encompasses the South Coast, Salton Sea, and Mojave air basins, two of which are considered non-attainment. The transition to zero-emission and the increase in ridership will have substantial benefits to air quality. This project will be the first phase of the zero-emission transition and will include the procurement of 67 zero-emission buses, which will be in service by 2030 or sooner. This accounts for a reduction of 10,037 MTCO₂e, or the equivalent of 2,234 vehicles off the road. Infrastructure improvements will also include the installation of renewable energy sources such as solar and battery storage units for added resiliency. It is estimated that this program will be a combined reduction of 147,570 MTCO₂e and equivalent to removing 32,839 vehicles off of the road.	
3. Expected Project Benefits (Ridership)	
The proposed infrastructure components and rolling stock will help transit operators maintain their fleet in a state of good repair, reduce costly roadside breakdowns, and improve safety and service reliability. As part of the procurement of buses, transit operators will include the installation of integrated passenger fare systems such as an open loop fare payments that allows riders to utilize their credit or debit or EBT cards for fare payment. This added convenience also attracts more discretionary riders and reduces the barriers to utilizing transit as a regular travel mode. It is estimated that features such as this can increase ridership by about 5% to 10%, or about 28,500 to 57,000 trips per year on the 67 new buses.	
4. Explanation of project benefits to disadvantaged communities, low-income communities, or low-income households as defined by SB 535 and AB 1550.	
According to CalEnviroScreen 4.0, various components of the proposed project are located directly in census tracts identified as disadvantaged communities. The Zero Emission and Transit Capital components of the project include stations, facility improvements, and routes throughout Riverside County. These routes serve a majority of the county, which contains 105 census tracts categorized as disadvantaged. The total population found in these tracts total over 570,000. Additionally, there are 64 census tracts identified as being in the 75th percentile and above for poverty rates. The population within these tracts total approximately 325,000. Rider demographic data also reaffirms that transit services are primarily used by transit-dependent populations. For example, the most recent customer survey conducted by RTA which serves the majority of the county population found that about 81% of riders identify as low-income, 85% minorities, and 75% do not have another form of transportation and rely solely on the bus.	

Zero Emission and Transit Capital Projects - Site Location

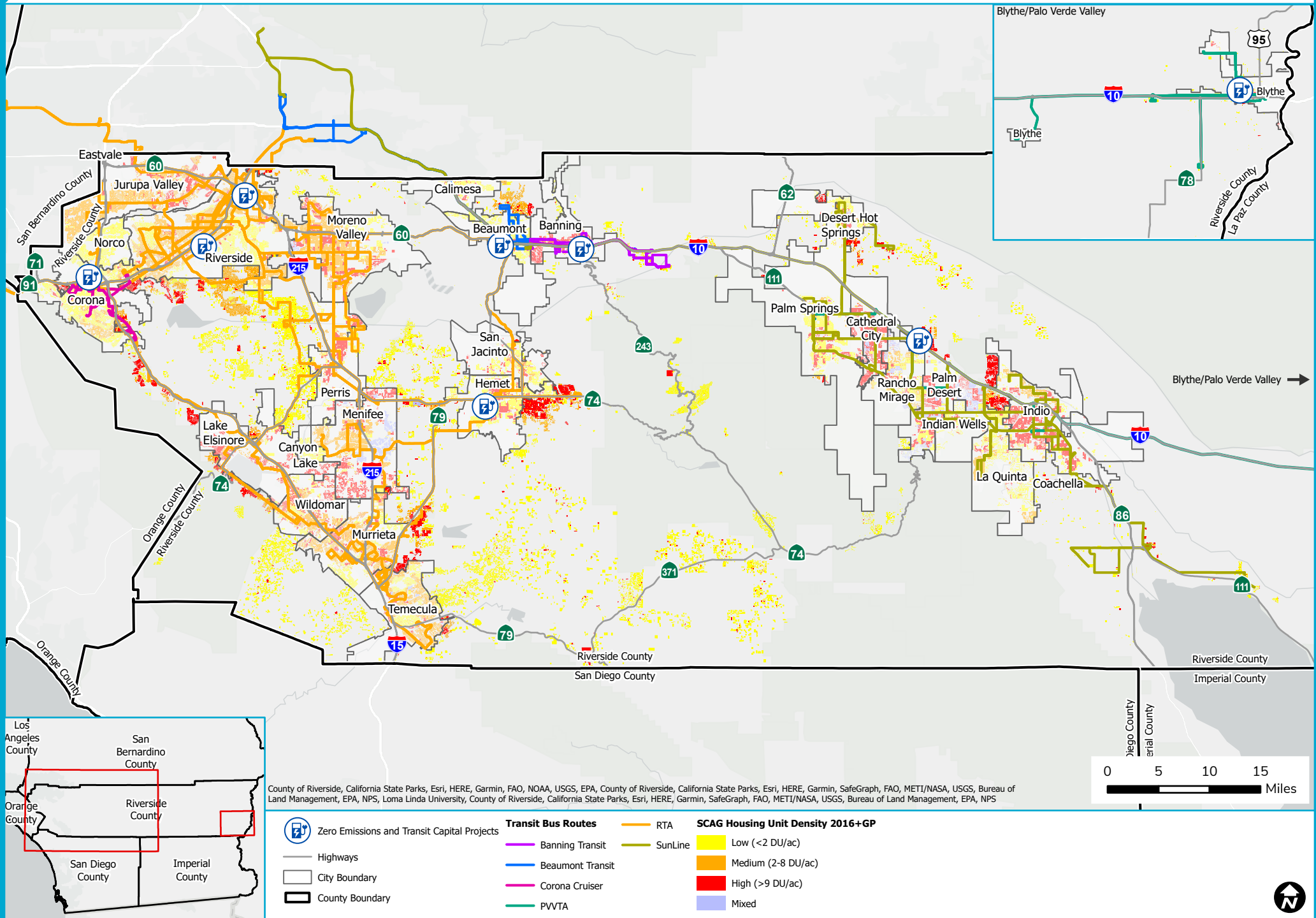


Zero Emission and Transit Capital Projects - Transportation Infrastructure

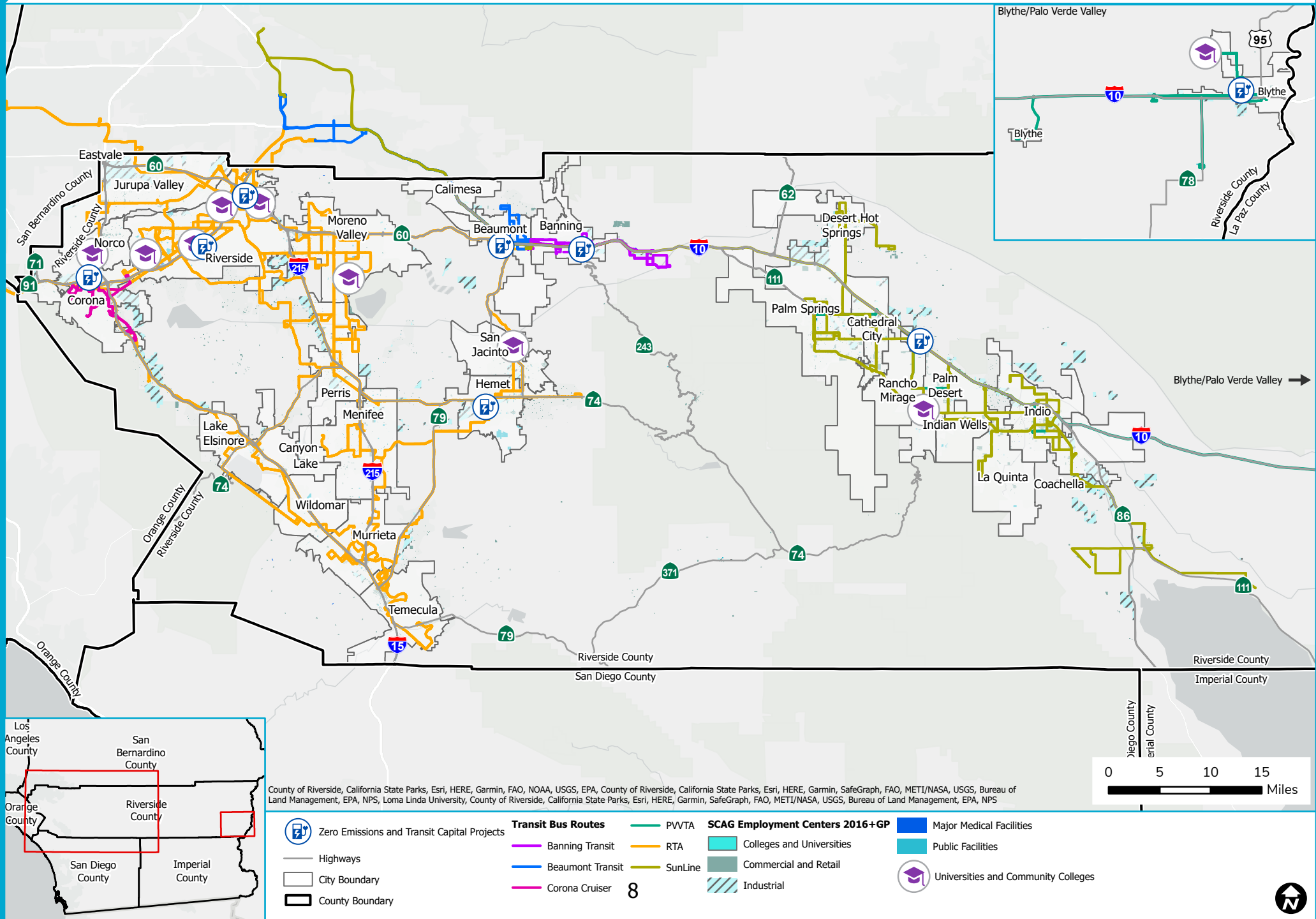


County of Riverside, California State Parks, Esri, HERE, Garmin, FAO, NOAA, USGS, EPA, County of Riverside, California State Parks, Esri, HERE, Garmin, SafeGraph, FAO, METI/NASA, USGS, Bureau of Land Management, EPA, NPS, Loma Linda University, County of Riverside, California State Parks, Esri, HERE, Garmin, SafeGraph, FAO, METI/NASA, USGS, Bureau of Land Management, EPA, NPS

Zero Emission and Transit Capital Projects - Housing Density



Zero Emission and Transit Capital Projects - Employment Centers



SB125 Allocation Package – Project Details

Project Type:	New TIRCP Project Development	Date:	12/22/2023
Implementing Agencies:	RCTC, County of Riverside, Cities of Banning and Beaumont		
Project Title:	Passenger Rail Project Development		
Project Manager/Contact	Phone	E-mail Address	
Lorelle Moe-Luna, Multimodal Services Director	Mobile: (951) 529-5815	lmoe-luna@rctc.org	

Summary of Project Scope

Passenger Rail Project Development includes the planning and preliminary engineering for expanded passenger rail service and grade separation improvements along the Coachella Valley Rail (CV Rail) corridor. The project will include the CV Rail Tier 2 Project-level environmental document and preliminary engineering of grade separations at Pennsylvania Ave (Beaumont), Hargrave Ave (Banning), and Broadway (unincorporated County of Riverside).

CV Rail Tier 2 project-level environmental will provide preliminary engineering along the 77.5-mile eastern section of track from Colton to Coachella, including six stations, a new third main track, and signal improvements on the eastern section of the corridor. The entire corridor is a 144-miles and will offer service from LA Union Station to Coachella. See corridor map below.

The grade separations are situated in the San Geronio-Pass area. The proposed projects would eliminate the existing at-grade Union Pacific Railroad crossings at Pennsylvania Ave, Hargrave Ave, and Broadway by constructing new rail bridges and new underpasses. There are currently two tracks and improvements will be able to accommodate at least three tracks. Improved sidewalks and bike lanes will also be included.

RCTC, in partnership with the County of Riverside and cities of Banning and Beaumont intend to apply for construction funding for the grade separations in future TIRCP Competitive cycles as well as other state and federal discretionary programs within the next two to three years when design is complete. Since the grade separations will complete design in the same timeframe, the hope is to combine efforts and compete for construction funds together in an effort to leverage local funding and maximize competitiveness. RCTC will also seek future TIRCP Competitive cycles for design and construction for the CV Rail Project.

Project Schedule and Milestones – CV Rail			Proposed Completion Date
Begin Environmental Phase	Document Type	EIR/EIS	12/1/2024
End Environmental Phase			12/30/2029

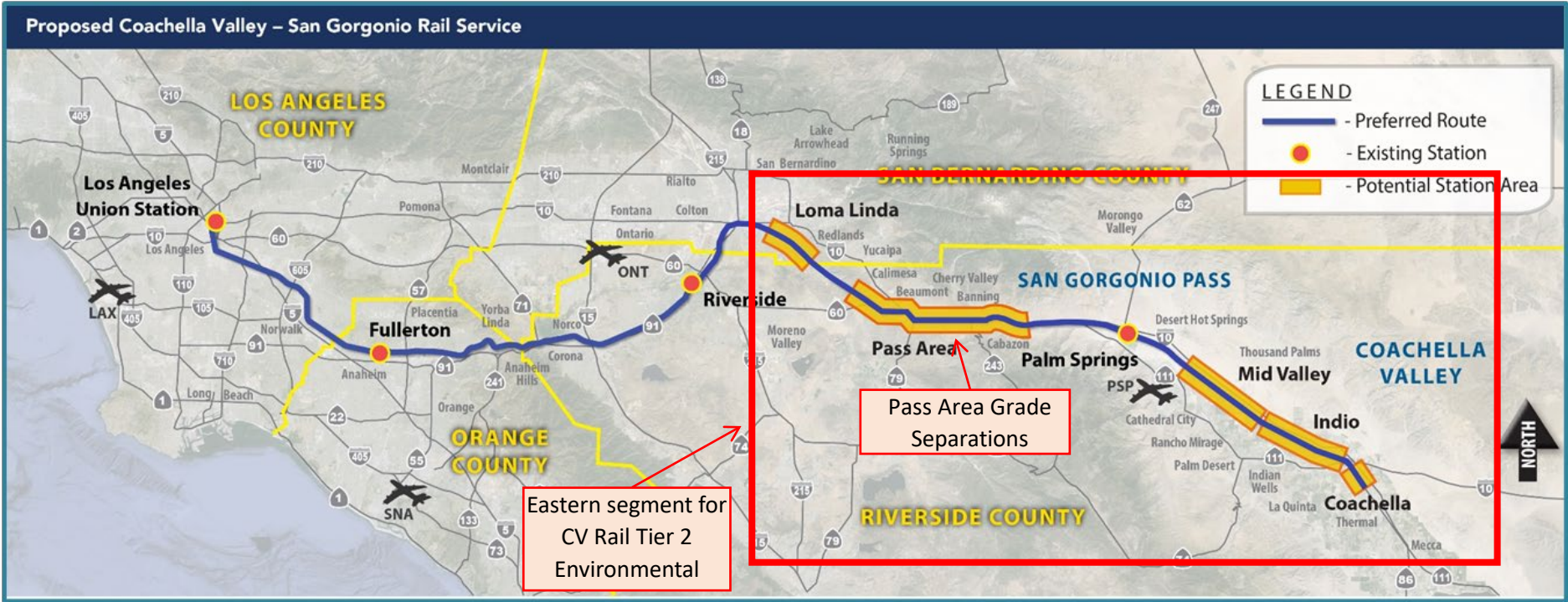
Project Schedule and Milestones – Grade Separations			Proposed Completion Date
Begin Environmental Phase	Document Type	CE	12/1/2022
End Environmental Phase			12/30/2025
Begin Design Phase			9/1/2024
End Design Phase			12/30/2027

Total Project Costs (\$1,000s)				
	TIRCP Formula	ZETCP	Other*	Total
PE	\$ 60,000,000		\$ 60,000,000	\$ 120,000,000
ROW				\$ -
CON				\$ -

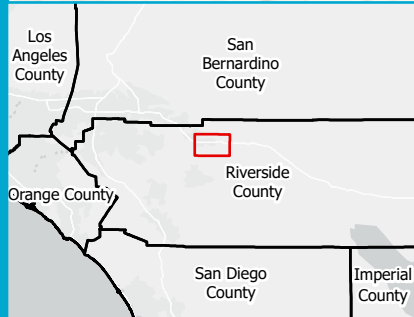
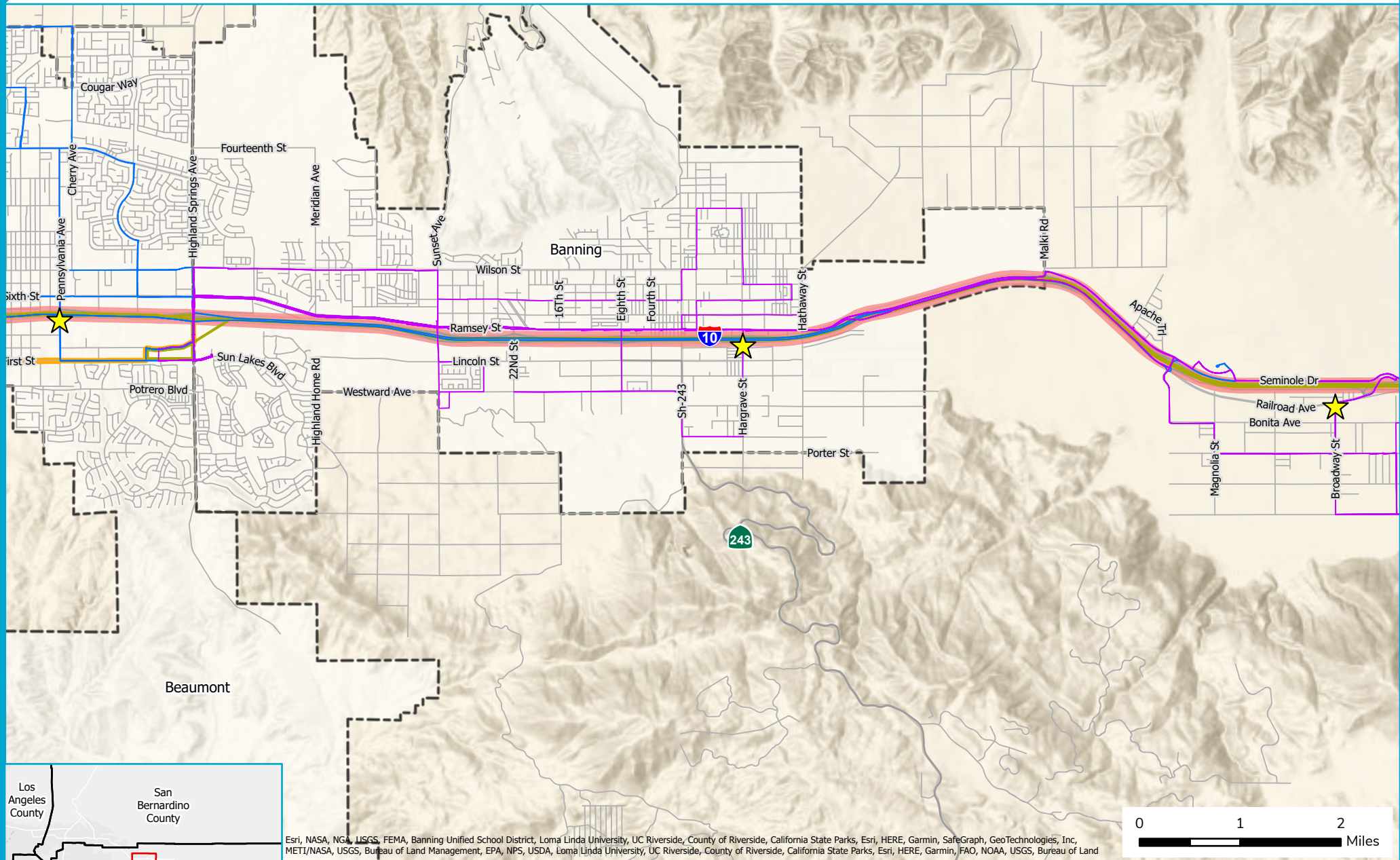
*Other fund sources include STIP, STA, federal Railroad Crossing Elimination, and local funds. The local agencies will actively seek construction funds through TIRCP Competitive, SB1 Programs, and federal discretionary programs such as CRISI and MPDG. CV Rail was recently added to the FRA Corridor ID Program. Acceptance into this program is a pathway for future federal rail funding. RCTC, in conjunction with Caltrans, will also seek competitive funds for construction through various state and federal discretionary programs. RCTC has also identified the project in its Traffic Relief Plan which could lead to a new local measure.

1. Is this for an existing TIRCP project? If yes, please explain the reason for additional funds being needed and skip #2, 3, and 4.	☐ Yes ☒ No
2. Greenhouse Gas Reductions Benefits	
The CV Rail project is consistent with the State Rail Plan and its commitment to reducing GHG emissions and other pollutants. Based on ridership and VMT projections prepared for the Tier 1/ Program-level EIS/EIR, passenger rail use within the Program Corridor would decrease greenhouse gas emissions by over 2,600 metric tons in the opening year. The grade separations will reduce congestion by increasing traffic flow, which result in fewer traffic accidents, traffic delays, engine idling, and unproductive fuel-burning both in the project location and along I-10 and surrounding roadways.	
3. Expected Project Benefits (Ridership)	
The proposed project would expand rail service along the corridor without degrading freight or existing long-distance passenger rail service. It is estimated that the project will attract about 338,500 boardings annually by 2044. Another benefit to this project is the proximity of existing bus services in the area and the potential for service expansion and improved service reliability. For example, local bus operators are reporting that trains can delay the bus about 10 minutes per trip, making it difficult to regain on-time performance. Additionally, current freight rail volumes average 42 trains per day (Caltrans, 2018), and in more recent years, the trains have increased up to 3 miles in length. At certain points, there have been incidents where freight trains were stopped in the area causing safety issues and prevented emergency vehicles from reaching isolated communities like Cabazon near the Morongo reservation.	
4. Explanation of project benefits to disadvantaged communities, low-income communities, or low-income households as defined by SB 535 and AB 1550.	
The expanded passenger rail service would provide a reliable alternative mode of transportation and employment options to communities where a high percentage of the population have incomes below the poverty level, with many exceeding the federal average poverty rate of 11.4% as of the 2019 American Community Survey (US Census Bureau 2020). Seven of the eight incorporated cities in the Coachella Valley, containing approximately 90% of the valley's population, have poverty rates that exceed 11.4%. Three of the eight incorporated cities have poverty rates that exceed 20% (Coachella, Cathedral City, and Desert Hot Springs). And in the San Geronio pass area, the city of Banning and the unincorporated community of Cabazon also have poverty rates that exceeds 20%. The project corridor is also majority rural (54%) with urban pockets of some of the fastest growing communities in the state.	

Coachella Valley Rail Corridor Map



Passenger Rail Project Development - Site Location



Esri, NASA, NGA, USGS, FEMA, Banning Unified School District, Loma Linda University, UC Riverside, County of Riverside, California State Parks, Esri, HERE, Garmin, SafeGraph, GeoTechnologies, Inc, METI/NASA, USGS, Bureau of Land Management, EPA, NPS, USDA, Loma Linda University, UC Riverside, County of Riverside, California State Parks, Esri, HERE, Garmin, FAO, NOAA, USGS, Bureau of Land



Grade Separations

CV Rail Corridor

Bus Routes

- Banning Transit
- Beaumont Transit
- RTA Bus Routes

SunLine Routes

Highways

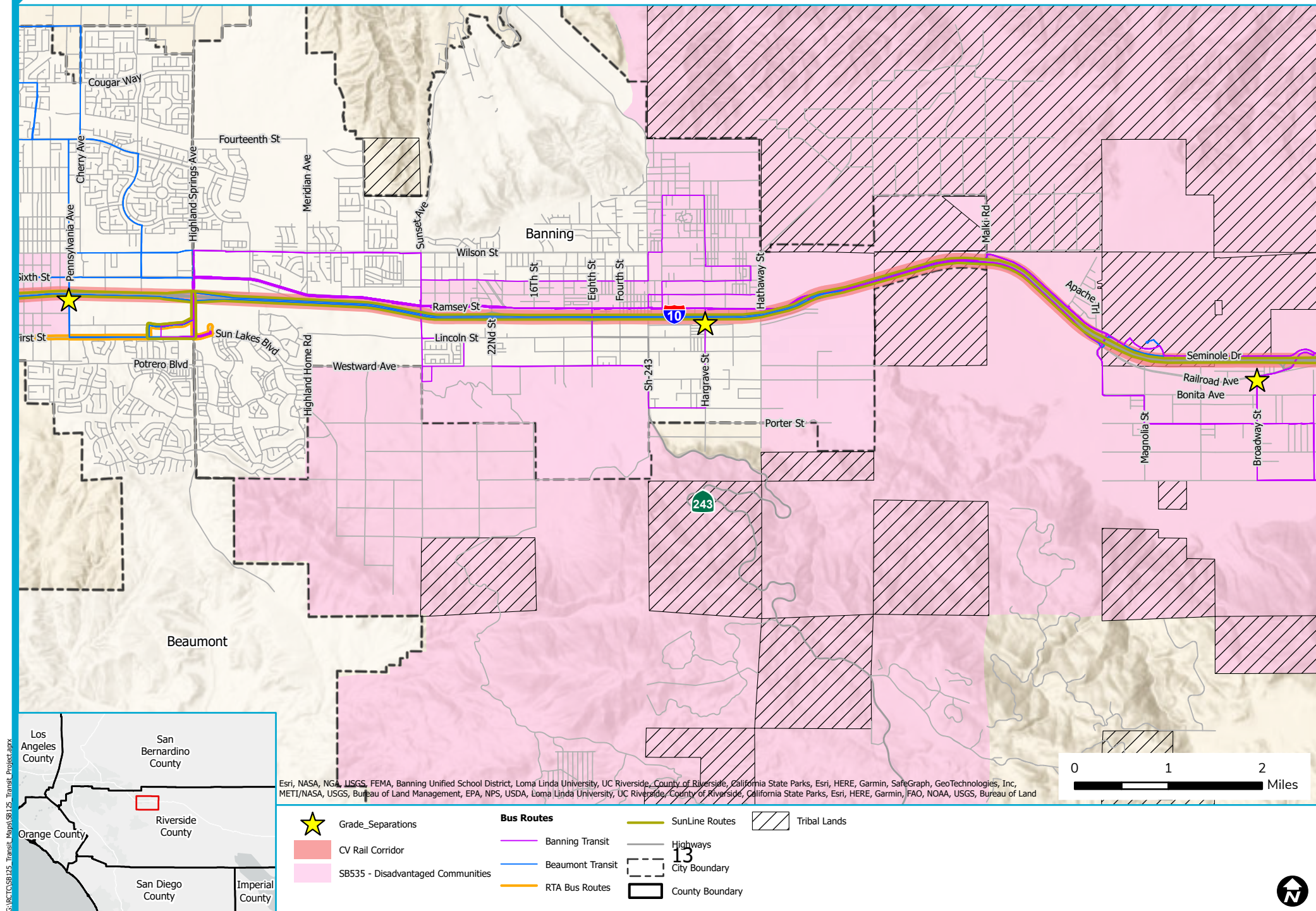
City Boundary

County Boundary

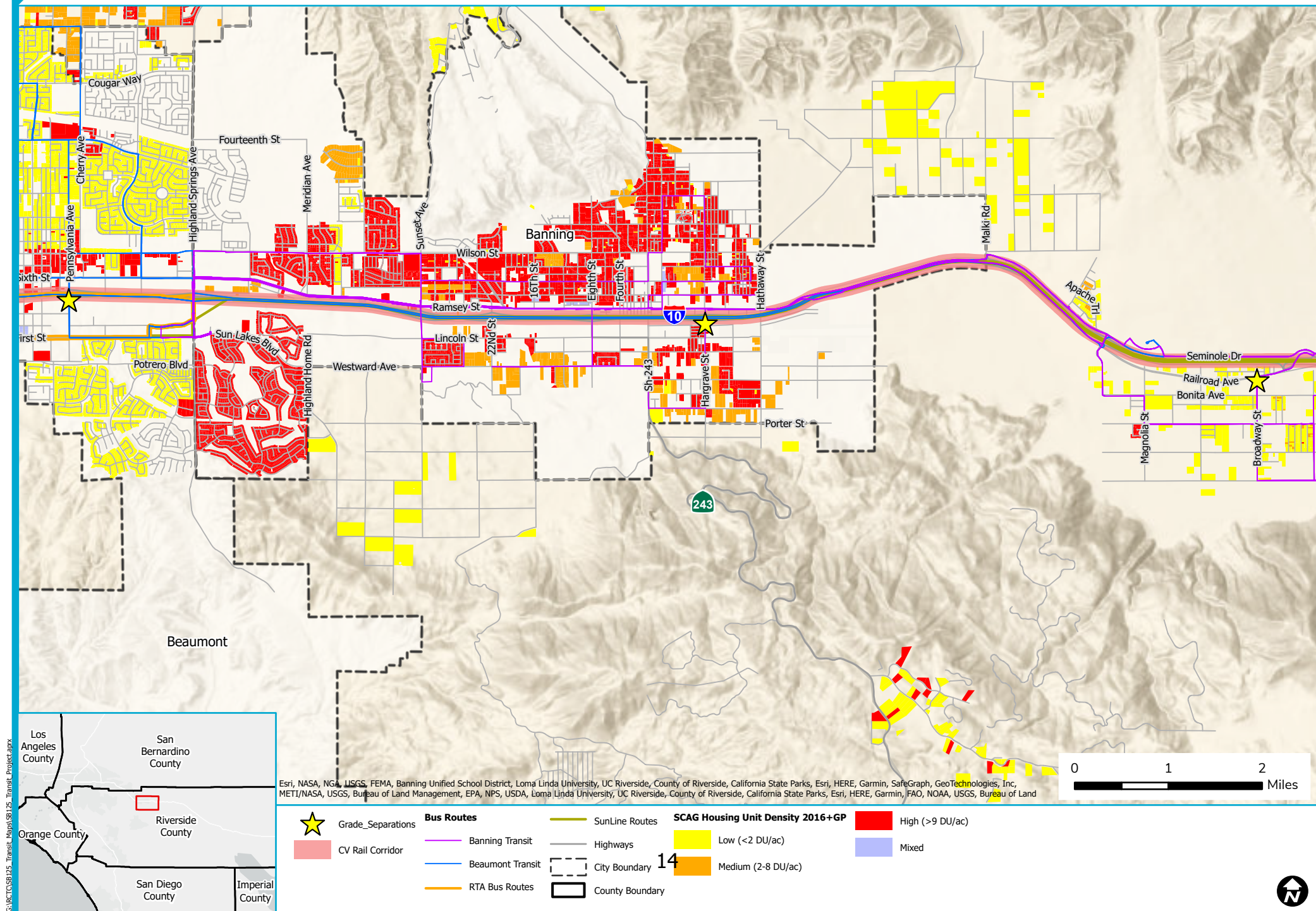
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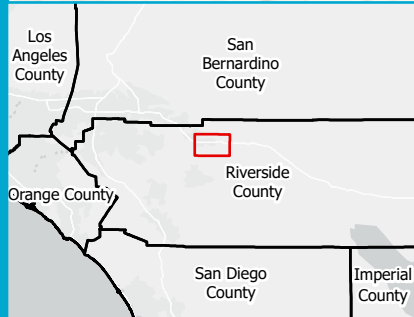
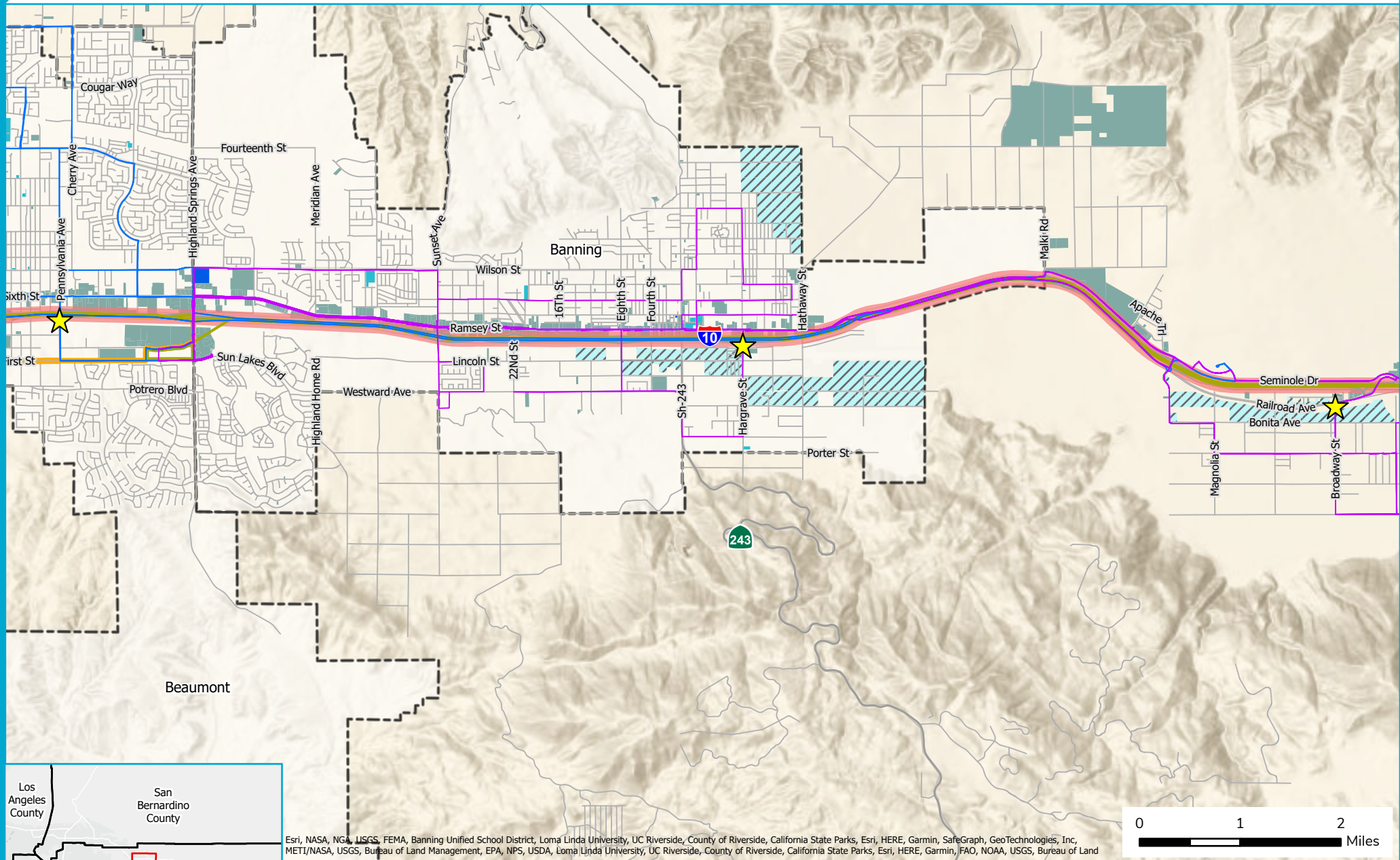
Passenger Rail Project Development- Transportation Infrastructure



Passenger Rail Project Development - Housing Density



Passenger Rail Project Development- Employment Centers



- | | | | | |
|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------|--|--------------------------|
| Grade Separations | Bus Routes | SunLine Routes | SCAG Employment Centers 2016+GP | Industrial |
| CV Rail Corridor | Banning Transit | Highways | Colleges and Universities | Major Medical Facilities |
| | Beaumont Transit | City Boundary | Commercial and Retail | Public Facilities |
| | RTA Bus Routes | County Boundary | | |



3. Summary Excel table by Proposed Use and Fiscal Year of Availability

The Excel (.xls) file is also included in the transmittal.

				Capital	Total
RTPA	Implementing Agenc-y/-ies	Project	Fund Source	FY24-25	
RCTC	RTA, SunLine, PVVTA, Cities of Banning, Beaumont, Corona and Riverside	ZE & Transit Capital Program	TIRCP	\$ 62,591,486	\$ 62,591,486
RCTC	RTA, Corona	ZE & Transit Capital Program	ZETCP (PTA)	\$ 6,871,647	\$ 6,871,647
RCTC	RTA, Corona	ZE & Transit Capital Program	ZETCP (GGRF)	\$ 7,956,643	\$ 7,956,643
RCTC	RCTC	Administrative Share	TIRCP	\$ 791,214	\$ 791,214
RCTC	Cities of Banning and Beaumont, County of Riverside and RCTC	Passenger Rail Project Development	TIRCP	\$ 60,000,000	\$ 60,000,000
Grand Total				\$ 138,210,990	\$ 138,210,990

4. Regionally Representative Transit Operator Data

Transit Operator	i. Existing fleet and asset management plans
Banning	https://www.rctc.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/12/December-Commission-Agenda.pdf
Beaumont	https://www.rctc.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/12/December-Commission-Agenda.pdf
Corona	https://www.rctc.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/12/December-Commission-Agenda.pdf
Riverside	https://www.rctc.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/12/December-Commission-Agenda.pdf
RTA	https://ww2.arb.ca.gov/sites/default/files/2021-03/RTA_ZEB_ROP_ADA12212020.pdf
SunLine	https://ww2.arb.ca.gov/sites/default/files/2020-09/SunLine_ROP_ADA09082020.pdf
PVVTA	https://www.rctc.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/12/December-Commission-Agenda.pdf
Metrolink	www.metrolinktrains.com/globalassets/about/agency/sustainability/reports/metrolink-rail-fleet-management-plan-update---full-report.pdf

Transit Operator	ii. Revenue collection methods and annual costs			
	Payment instruments of revenue collection	Revenue	Costs	Planned capital costs related to Fare Collection
Banning	Cash, checks, money orders, Token Transit and credit card payments	\$ 80,497	\$ 23,204	\$ -
Beaumont	Cash, cards, Token Transit, and Chargepoint	\$ 206,348	\$ 27,853	\$ -
Corona	Cash (paid to the bus driver at time of boarding) and paper fare-media	\$ 237,669	\$ 16,000	\$ -
Riverside	Cash and Check	\$ 257,631	\$ 26,247	\$ -
RTA	Cash/coin, passes, mobile pass, wifi enabled debit/credit card	\$ 6,500,000	\$ 200,000	\$ 500,000
SunLine	Cash/coin, passes, mobile pass, wifi enabled debit/credit card	\$ 1,718,198	\$ 72,580	\$ -
PVVTA	Cash, passes and credit cards	\$ 70,138	\$ 4,166	\$ 80,000
Metrolink	Cash, passes, credit cards, mobile pass	\$ 31,257,252 *	\$ 5,701,471 *	\$ 3,100,000 *

Totals \$ 40,327,733 \$ 6,071,521 \$ 3,680,000

*See Appendix F for Metrolink details. Total includes ARROW which was only 8 months in FY23.

Transit Operator	iii. Statement of existing service plan and GTFS feed schedule	
	Statement of existing service planned service changes through the end of FY 2023/24	Schedule of GTFS feed data
Banning	No significant service changes are expected through the end of FY 23/24	Agency has one service change every August, minor changes if needed in January. GTFS feed updates within 1 to 2 days.*
Beaumont	No significant service changes are expected through the end of FY 23/24	Agency has one service change every July, minor changes only as needed in January. GTFS feed updates within 1 to 2 days.*
Corona	No significant service changes are expected through the end of FY 23/24	Agency does not have a set service change schedule, schedule updates occur about every other year. GTFS feed updates within 1 to 2 days.*
Riverside	No significant service changes are expected through the end of FY 23/24	N/A - offers demand/reservation services only.
RTA	No significant service changes are expected through the end of FY 23/24	RTA has service changes every January, May, and September. GTFS feed updates within in 1 to 2 days.
SunLine	No significant service changes are expected through the end of FY 23/24	Service changes occur every September and May and the GTFS feed updates within 1 to 2 days.
PVVTa	No significant service changes are expected through the end of FY 23/24	Service changes are made in July and the GTFS feed updates within 1 to 2 days.*
Metrolink	Metrolink is operating at about 90% service levels from pre-Covid. No significant service changes are expected through the end of FY 23/24.	Services changes occur every April and October. GTFS feeds are updated within 1 to 2 days of the change.

*RCTC holds the contract with Trillium to update the GTFS feeds for the small operators.

Transit Operator	iv. Expenditures on safety and security, and cyber security	v. Opportunities for service restructuring, eliminating service redundancies, and improving coordination amongst transit operators, including, but not limited to, consolidation of agencies or reevaluation of network management and governance structure.
Banning	\$ 31,000	RCTC as the RTPA, is heavily involved in the short-range and long-range planning processes of the transit operators to provide regional context to local plans. RCTC ensures regional coordination of services and leads major regional projects such as the extension of passenger rail services and major regional studies and analyses such as the Next Generation Rail Study, Inland Empire Comprehensive Multimodal Corridor Plan, and the most recent Core Capacity Innovative Transit Study.
Beaumont	\$ 21,992	
Corona	\$ 14,200	
Riverside	\$ 66,948	
RTA	\$ 1,300,000	
SunLine	\$ 2,794,723	
PVVTA	\$ 10,462	
Metrolink	\$ 17,420,507 *	RCTC and other member agencies of SCRRA are involved in the service planning process each year. Metrolink is working on a Service Growth Development Plan that will help layout how schedules will be optimized, and service can grow while targeting new markets and riders.

*See Appendix F for Metrolink details. Total includes ARROW which was only 8 months in FY23.

5. Summary of Monthly Ridership

Monthly ridership reports will be posted on RCTC's website here: www.rctc.org/ridershipreports.

6. Long-Term Financial Plan

As required in the guidelines, a long-term financial plan will be submitted by June 30, 2026.